EPISODIO

13

trece

La búsqueda

The search

TEXTBOOK PP. 129–139 · WORKBOOK PP. 128–139

LO ESENCIAL *In one minute*

1. **The past for I and you**: *-ar* **-é, -aste**, *-er* and *-ir* **-í, -iste**: *llegué, llegaste · decidí, decidiste*. The *yo* form changes its spelling: bus**qué**, lle**gué**, almor**cé**. And *ver* has no accents: **vi, vio**.
2. **me, te, nos, os** = me, you, us, you all: *Arturo **me** invitó.* · *¡José! **Te** buscan.* To *usted*: **lo** to a man, **la** to a woman: *¿En qué puedo servir**la**?*
3. **In a shop**: **Deme…** = give me, **Cóbreme** = ring it up: *Deme medio kilo de calamares, por favor.* **me gustan** + plural: *Me gustan los mariscos.*
4. **se** in the plural can mean *each other*: *Nos llamamos* = we call each other · *se comprenden* = they understand each other.

EN UNA TIENDA *In a shop*

Deme un kilo de calamares, por favor.	*Give me a kilo of squid, please.*	Direct, and normal in a shop. *por favor* makes it softer. The books write **déme**; today's spelling is **deme**.
Deme medio kilo de manteca.	*Let me have half a kilo of butter.*	**un kilo** · **medio kilo**: the metric system. *manteca* is butter in Argentina; elsewhere **mantequilla** (*manteca* = lard).
Cóbreme esto, por favor.	*Ring this up for me, please.*	From *cobrar* = to charge.
¿Necesitan algo más?	*Do you need anything else?*	What the clerk asks.

EL VERBO *buscar · looked for · the past*

buscar *looked for · the past*

SINGULAR			PLURAL		
yo	**busqué**	*I looked for*	nosotros/as	**buscamos**	*we looked for*
tú	**buscaste**	*you looked for*	vosotros/as	**buscasteis**	*you looked for*
él · ella · usted	**buscó**	*he, she looked for · you looked for*	ellos · ellas · ustedes	**buscaron**	*they looked for · you looked for*

REMEMBER

Only the *yo* form changes its spelling: **qu** before *é* keeps the *k* sound, as in *que* (Episode 3). No *for* after *buscar*: *Busqué la dirección* = I looked for the address.

GRAMÁTICA *How it works*

The past for yo: -qué, -gué, -cé

The full table of endings is in **Episode 12**. To keep the stem's sound before **-é**, three groups of *-ar* verbs change their spelling, in the *yo* form only:

	INFINITIVE	YO	THE OTHERS
-car: **-qué**	buscar	bus**qué**	buscaste, buscó…
-gar: **-gué**	llegar	lle**gué**	llegaste, llegó…
-zar: **-cé**	almorzar	almor**cé**	almorzaste, almorzó…

Llegué a Buenos Aires y **tomé** un taxi a mi hotel. — *I arrived in Buenos Aires and took a taxi to my hotel.*

Yo **volví** al hotel y tú **volviste** a casa. Luego **llamé** a México. — *I went back to the hotel and you went home. Then I called Mexico.*

WATCH OUT — The others you know: **-car** *dedicarse, explicar, sacar* · **-gar** *investigar* · **-zar** *comenzar, empezar* (empe**cé**). And **ver** has no accents: *vi, viste, vio*. *yo* and *él* differ only in the last vowel: lle**gué** (I) · lle**gó** (he).

me, te, nos, os: me, you, us

The full set of words for *me, you, him, her, it, us, them*. *lo, la, los, las* are in **Episode 12**; **me, te, nos, os** only ever mean people, so they have no masculine or feminine.

	ONE	MORE THAN ONE
I · we	**me** = me	**nos** = us
you, familiar	**te** = you (*tú*)	**os** = you (*vosotros*)
you, formal · he, she, they	**lo** · **la** = you (*Ud.*), him, her, it	**los** · **las** = you (*Uds.*), them

Arturo **me** ha invitado a cenar. — *Arturo has invited me to dinner.*

¡José! **Te** buscan. — *José! Someone's looking for you.*

WATCH OUT — To **usted**, choose by the person: *¿En qué puedo servir**la**, señora?* · *¿En qué puedo servir**lo**, señor?* Same place as always: before the verb, or joined to an infinitive.

With or without se

Many verbs with *se* (Episode 9) also work without it. Without *se*, you do the action **to someone else**:

	TO SOMEONE ELSE	TO YOURSELF
despertar(se)	El teléfono **despertó** a Raquel.	Raquel **se despertó** a las seis.
vestir(se)	Elena **vistió** a Jaime…	…y después **se vistió** también.
a new meaning	**dormir** = to sleep · **ir** = to go	**dormirse** = to fall asleep · **irse** = to go away (Episodes 8–9)

Nos llamamos por teléfono con frecuencia. — *We call each other often.*

¿Crees que Raquel y Arturo **se comprenden**? — *Do you think Raquel and Arturo understand each other?*

WATCH OUT — In the plural, **nos, os, se** can also mean **each other**: *Mis padres y yo nos visitamos con frecuencia.* Learn to recognise it.

Small rules, big difference

me gustan + a plural noun; **no me gusta nada** = I don't like it at all (Episode 4)	*Me gustan mucho los calamares. · No me gusta nada el atún.*
Entre … **y** …, **prefiero** … = of … and …, I prefer …	*Entre el salmón y el atún, prefiero el salmón.*
Cooking: **a la plancha** (grilled), **al horno** (baked), **frito** (fried), **asado** (roast), **al ajillo** (in garlic and oil)	*¿Cómo te gusta el pescado? —A la plancha.*
la primera vez · **la última vez** = the first time · the last time	*La última vez que vi a mi hermano fue aquí.*
la Argentina, el Brasil, el Uruguay, el Paraguay take *el, la*; **Chile, Bolivia, Colombia** don't. Not every speaker keeps this.	*Raquel está en la Argentina.*

PRONUNCIACIÓN *How it sounds*

s, z, ci, ce: one sound in Latin America

s, **z**, and **c** before *e, i* all sound like English *s*: *ciudad, cenar, azul, arroz, conozco, mariscos*. Keep it a hiss: *casa, presidente*, never the *z* of English *rose*.

z, ci, ce in Spain: th

In most of Spain **z** and **c** before *e, i* sound like *th* in *think*, while **s** stays *s*: *Santa Susana · el ciego, la voz, dicen, merluza*. Both are correct: choose one and keep to it.

s at the end of a syllable

In relaxed speech in Argentina, the Caribbean and southern Spain an **s** before a consonant or at the end of a word turns into a soft *h* or drops: *lo(h) mejillone(h)*. Learn to hear it; say the full *s* yourself.

FRASES ÚTILES *Ready to use*

Disculpe la molestia.	*Sorry to bother you.*
La última vez que vi a mi hermano fue aquí.	*The last time I saw my brother was here.*
Llegué a Buenos Aires y tomé un taxi a mi hotel.	*I arrived in Buenos Aires and took a taxi to my hotel.*
Arturo me ha invitado a cenar.	*Arturo has invited me to dinner.*
Estudié y también vi la televisión anoche.	*I studied and also watched television last night.*
¿Ya probaste la parrillada?	*Have you tried the mixed grill yet?*

VOCABULARIO *Words*

Learn these first. The lesson's own word list.

LOS VERBOS

almorzar (ue)	*to have lunch*
comenzar (ie)	*to begin*
comer	*to eat*
contar (ue)	*to count*
dormir (ue)	*to sleep*
invitar	*to invite*
irse	*to go away; to leave (for a place)*
preferir (ie)	*to prefer*
probar (ue)	*to try, taste (food)*
reconocer (reconozco)	*to recognize*

LAS PERSONAS

el · la dependiente	*clerk*
el marinero	*sailor*
todo el mundo	*everybody*

LOS LUGARES · LAS COSAS

el barco	*boat*
el negocio	*business; shop*
la tienda	*store*
el dinero	*money*

LOS CONCEPTOS

la búsqueda	*search*
la (primera · última) vez	*(first · last) time*

LOS MARISCOS

los calamares	*squid*
el cangrejo	*crab*
la langosta	*lobster*
el langostino	*prawn*
el mejillón	*mussel*
la ostra	*oyster*

EL PESCADO

el atún	*tuna*
el lenguado	*sole*
la merluza	*hake*
el salmón	*salmon*

OTROS COMESTIBLES

el aceite	*oil*
el arroz	*rice*
la ensalada	*salad*
la manteca (Arg.) · la mantequilla	*butter*
el pan	*bread*

LAS PALABRAS ADICIONALES

me gusta(n) (mucho)…	*I like… (a lot)*
no me gusta(n) (nada)…	*I don't like… (at all)*
en seguida	*immediately*
hace… (años, horas…)	*… (years, hours…) ago*
luego	*then, next; later*
anoche · ayer	*last night · yesterday*
fácilmente	*easily*
nunca	*never*

ALSO ON THE LIST **En una tienda**: see En una tienda above